

KUPRAVA CREATIVE

THE DEAFENING SILENCE

A LIGHT INSTALLATION
BY MIRANDA KUPRAVA
INSPIRED BY MELITA IOSAVA'S
DRAWING "FREEDOM"

CHILDREN. LIGHT. MEMORY.
FOR A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

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MELITA IOSAVA / ORIGINAL WORK

FREEDOM - THE ORIGIN

The Deafening Silence begins with Freedom, an original work by Melita Iosava. A field of blue, yellow balloons and small figures rising with them became the visual seed of the installation.

Miranda Kuprava translates that intimate image into a public environment at human scale: child-sized fiberglass figures, balloons, programmed light and a precise sequence of sound. The installation does not copy the drawing literally. It expands its central gesture - a child held between ground and sky - into a space the audience can physically enter.

The project is ultimately about sound, warning and indifference. A tragedy may be announced loudly, yet daily life can continue around it almost unchanged. The work asks what happens when the death of children becomes another item in the flow of information - heard, registered, and then allowed to disappear into ordinary life.

The figures are deliberately faceless and individualised only by scale and posture. They are not portraits of specific children. Their anonymity turns them into a collective presence: children who could belong to any street, any city, any family.

A child rises. The city continues below.

SOUND

No composed music. This page introduces the origin of the work before the installation sequence begins.

LIGHT

The blue and yellow of Melita's work become the conceptual color axis later used in the installation.



PROGRAM I / BEFORE THE INTERRUPTION

CITY ALIVE

The installation first appears as part of ordinary urban life. Its many colors create an open, luminous and almost celebratory landscape. Visitors move freely between the figures while the city continues around them.

This opening state is essential: the audience must first experience normality. There is no warning in the image itself, no memorial atmosphere and no instruction to mourn. The installation is simply present among traffic, footsteps, conversation and children's voices.

The children and balloons are made from neutral translucent fiberglass. They are never painted. Every visible color is produced by programmed light, allowing the same physical installation to change meaning without changing material.

Before the alarm, this is simply a living city.

SOUND

Live urban ambience: traffic, footsteps, fragments of conversation, children, bicycles, doors, distant laughter. No music. No Mahler.

LIGHT

Full multicolor program. The material remains neutral beneath the light.



PROGRAM I / THE CITY DOES NOT KNOW YET

ORDINARY LIFE

Color, movement and everyday sound establish a sense of safety. The audience is not positioned outside the work as a spectator; people walk through it and become part of the same field as the child figures.

The beauty of this stage is intentional. The later transformation only has force if the audience first experiences the ease with which a bright public space can be accepted as normal.

The work therefore begins not with catastrophe, but with continuity - the familiar rhythm of a city that assumes the next moment will resemble the one before it.

Normality is the first material of the work.

SOUND

City life continues at normal volume. No composed soundtrack is introduced.

LIGHT

Multicolor illumination remains active across balloons, ground reflections and figures.



PROGRAM II / INTERRUPTION

AIR-RAID ALARM

Without warning, the ordinary city sound is cut by an air-raid siren. At the same moment, the multicolor lighting disappears. The visual world contracts to yellow above and blue below.

The balloons glow yellow. Blue light spreads across the ground. The children themselves remain neutral, pale fiberglass. Nothing physical has moved or been replaced; only sound and light have changed.

This sudden reduction is the project's first rupture. A familiar public space becomes a space of danger in seconds. The siren is not background sound - it is a command to notice.

The warning is loud. The question is whether we still hear it.

SOUND

AIR-RAID SIREN. Ordinary city ambience is interrupted. No music and no Mahler yet.

LIGHT

Yellow balloons / blue ground. All multicolor programming switches off.



PROGRAM II / THE WARNING CONTINUES

YELLOW ABOVE. BLUE BELOW.

The siren continues while the installation holds its yellow-and-blue state. The image is visually beautiful, but the sound refuses to let that beauty remain decorative.

The project deliberately creates this contradiction. We are accustomed to receiving images of war through screens, headlines and short clips. Even unbearable events can become visually familiar. The installation places that contradiction in physical space, where the visitor cannot scroll past it.

The child figures are still exactly where they were during the colorful city sequence. Their unchanged presence makes the transformation more disturbing: danger has entered ordinary life without asking permission.

A signal can be deafening and still be ignored.

SOUND

The air-raid siren continues. No Mahler yet.

LIGHT

Yellow balloon light and blue floor light remain the only programmed colors.



PROGRAM III / MAHLER BEGINS

THE ALARM STOPS

Then the siren stops. Programmed color disappears. The balloons no longer glow yellow and the blue floor illumination is switched off. The neutral fiberglass remains visible only through the surrounding ambient light.

Into that visual silence enters Gustav Mahler's *Kindertotenlieder* - Songs on the Death of Children. The transition is intentionally severe: alarm gives way not to relief, but to mourning.

This is the emotional centre of *The Deafening Silence*. The title describes a paradox: the world can be full of warnings, reports and images, yet our response can still be silence. When children die and the surrounding world continues its routine, silence becomes not an absence of sound but an ethical condition.

The installation does not accuse an individual viewer. It asks a collective question: how much tragedy can a society absorb before attention becomes numb and another death becomes merely another notification?

The siren warns of danger. When it stops, what remains is our response.

SOUND

Gustav Mahler - *Kindertotenlieder* begins. The air-raid siren has stopped completely. No city ambience.

LIGHT

Programmed installation lighting OFF. Neutral fiberglass is visible only through ambient environmental light.



PROGRAM IV / MAHLER CONTINUES

THE LIGHT RETURNS

Slowly, the yellow balloon light and blue ground light return. Mahler does not stop. The installation becomes visible again, but the audience can no longer encounter it as they did at the beginning.

The return of light is not a return to normality. The multicolor city does not come back. The experience has been permanently narrowed to yellow, blue and the pale presence of the children.

This final state turns illumination into memory. The same yellow light that first appeared beautiful now carries the knowledge of the siren, the blackout and the music that followed.

The light returns. The innocence of the first image does not.

SOUND

Mahler's Kindertotenlieder continues without interruption. No siren. No return to ordinary city sound.

LIGHT

Yellow balloons / blue ground return gradually. Children remain neutral and unpainted.



FINAL STATE / MEMORY AND INDIFFERENCE

THE DEAFENING SILENCE

The completed sequence is a cycle of perception: ordinary life, warning, silence, mourning and illuminated memory. Its meaning is carried equally by physical form, sound and the removal or return of light.

The work addresses the distance between knowing and responding. Contemporary audiences can receive news of children dying while continuing to work, travel, shop, talk and sleep. The project makes that uncomfortable coexistence spatial: visitors stand inside beauty while carrying the knowledge of what the sound sequence has revealed.

The children are not painted in national colors and are not literal portraits. The material remains neutral so that light can alter the emotional reading of the same bodies. This keeps the work focused on children as human beings before they become statistics, symbols or headlines.

The installation is conceived as a technically buildable public artwork: translucent fiberglass figures at real child scale; lightweight illuminated balloon forms; concealed structural suspension; programmable LED systems; controlled audio; and a timed show sequence that can repeat through the evening.

The Deafening Silence asks for no single prescribed reaction. It creates a moment in which looking away becomes perceptible.

When children die, the world often does not become quiet. It simply continues.

SOUND

Mahler continues through the final illuminated state.

LIGHT

Final controlled state: yellow balloons, blue ground, neutral fiberglass figures.



C R E A T I V E

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T I M E I S A N O T H E R M A T E R I A L .

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